



**TAL
TECH**

LECTURE 1 - INTRODUCTION SETTING THE SCENE

Mihkel Lauk
ITE4230 - Public Sector Service Design and Implementation
Tallinn University of Technology

14.04.2026

AGENDA

- Personal introduction
- Course introduction
- Service terminology
- E-governance maturity
- Homework introduction: country review
- The current state of e-governance
- Setting the scene – scope of the change
- Regulative influencers relevant to change

MIHKEL LAUK

- <https://www.linkedin.com/in/mihkellauk>
- Mihkel is Digital Transformation, eGovernance, and Performance Management expert with the very practical experience gained since 1996.
- Mihkel earned the master's degree in IT Management from EBS in 2007 and the ITIL Expert certification in 2016. Since 1998 Mihkel has consulted the public sector institutions in Estonia and abroad. Beside Estonia, Mihkel has exported his knowledge to several countries across the Globe: Finland, Ukraine, Kyrgyzstan, Moldova, Western Balkans, Czech Republic, Malaysia (Sarawak), Tonga Kingdom, Bermuda, Dubai, Saudi Arabia, Trinidad and Tobago.
- He has been among the authors of several Estonian digital transformation fundamentals, including Public Service Portfolio Management, Activity Based Budgeting, Performance Management, Competency Framework for Top Civil Service Executives, Data Quality Management, State Shared ICT Services, State ICT Development Reference Operating Model.
- Mihkel has taught students at Mainor Business School, IT College, Tartu Art College and the Estonian Academy of Arts, provided ICT training sessions at Invicta, IT Protraining, BCS Koolitus, TalTech.



INTRODUCTION TO THE COURSE: COMMUNICATION & PARTICIPATION

- Moodle – official source of materials, exam environment.
 - The Moodle course page will be finalised by September 15th.
 - The course content will be made available during the course in prior to every lecture.
- Teams – main channel for daily communication and consultation.
 - [ITE4230 autumn 2025](#)
 - All questions-answers will be available to all of you.
 - All lectures are being recorded and will be accessible for a limited time in Teams.
- Timetable: <https://tunniplan.taltech.ee/#/public/subject/116976>
- Lectures: mainly in SOC211a.
- 6 sessions in total, including:
 - Lectures
 - Course work consultation
 - Exam – special session will be agreed separately
- Time split: 50% lecture & 50% consultations on personal assignment and/or homework.

INTRODUCTION TO THE COURSE: OBJECTIVES & COURSE CONTENT

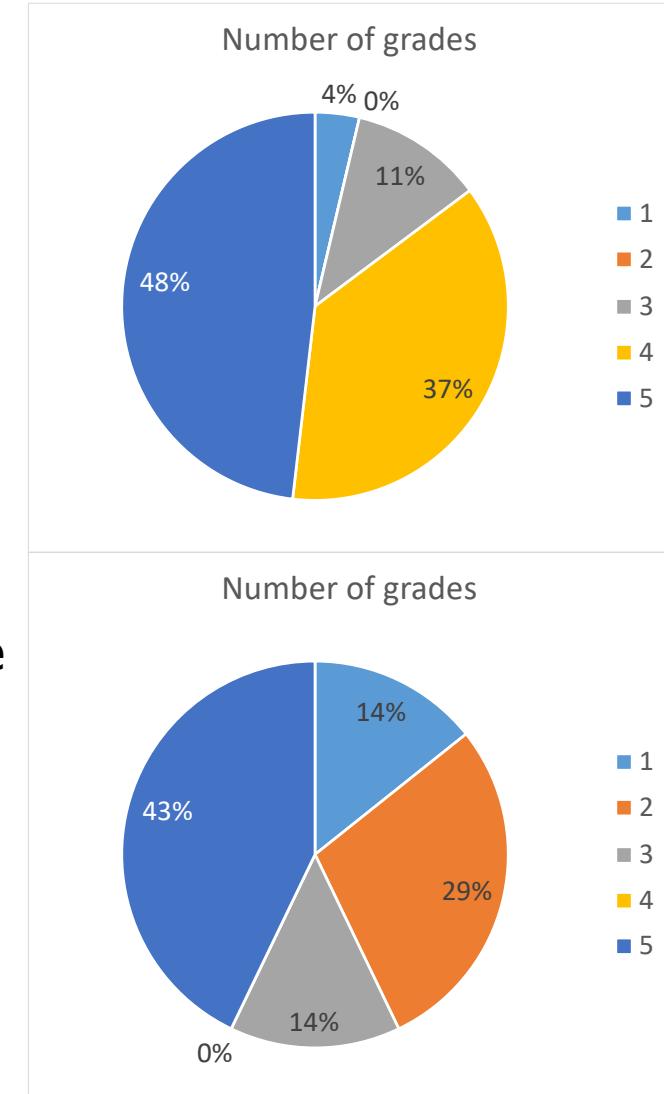
- The goal for the course is to provide you with an overall understanding and insight into service-orientation, design, and implementation and its use in the public sector.
- It will also give you an insight into different methodologies and concepts for communicating and implementing e-government initiatives.
- By the end of the course, you will be able to identify, name, analyse, map, and associate with the processes of organisations.
- Furthermore, you will also be able to define, create and criticise different e-government solutions and implementation strategies in the context of global and local trends.

INTRODUCTION TO THE COURSE: LECTURE TYPES

- Friday 05.09 – hybrid
- Friday 19.09 – online only
- Friday 03.10 – online only
- Wednesday 05.11 – hybrid
- Friday 07.11 - hybrid

INTRODUCTION TO THE COURSE: ASSESSMENT

- **Assessment form:** Personal Course Work and Exam.
- **Preparation:** pre-reading, home assignments.
- **Grading:**
 - 10% – Group work
 - 60% – Personal Course Work
 - 30% – Exam
 - For outstanding performance, bonus points may be earned.



INTRODUCTION TO THE COURSE: HOMEWORK

- 70% – Group Work and personal assignment, out of which:
- 10 points – Country Report
 - Each of You shall make a country review and present it at the coming session.
 - Choice of a country and grouping will be agreed separately.
 - Assessment criteria consist of completeness and quality of the presentation, relevance of topics presented and the use of time.
- 60 points – Personal Course Work
 - The aim of the case-based personal work is to create a hypothetical e-service that would contribute to e-society. Upgrade of an existing e-service or real-life example is a bonus. The development of a solution should follow the course structure: You should analyse each phase from the life-cycle of the chosen solution.

INTRODUCTION TO THE COURSE: EXAM

- 30% – Exam
- Part I : Multiple choice questions (10 points)
 - Based on the topics covered throughout the lectures
 - Number of questions to be confirmed
- Part II: Short-answer questions (20 points)
 - Five straight-forward questions
 - Limited space for answers

INTRODUCTION TO THE COURSE:

EXAM RULES

- Rule I : There is only one official exam date.
 - There is one preliminary date and it is optional.
 - There will be only one exam retake date.
- Rule II: Retaking a passed exam is not tolerated.
 - If you retake an exam that you have already passed, the first exam grade will be deleted and you will start from the blank page.
 - Retaking an exam is not a privilege.
- Rule III: You cannot take the exam without the home assignments.

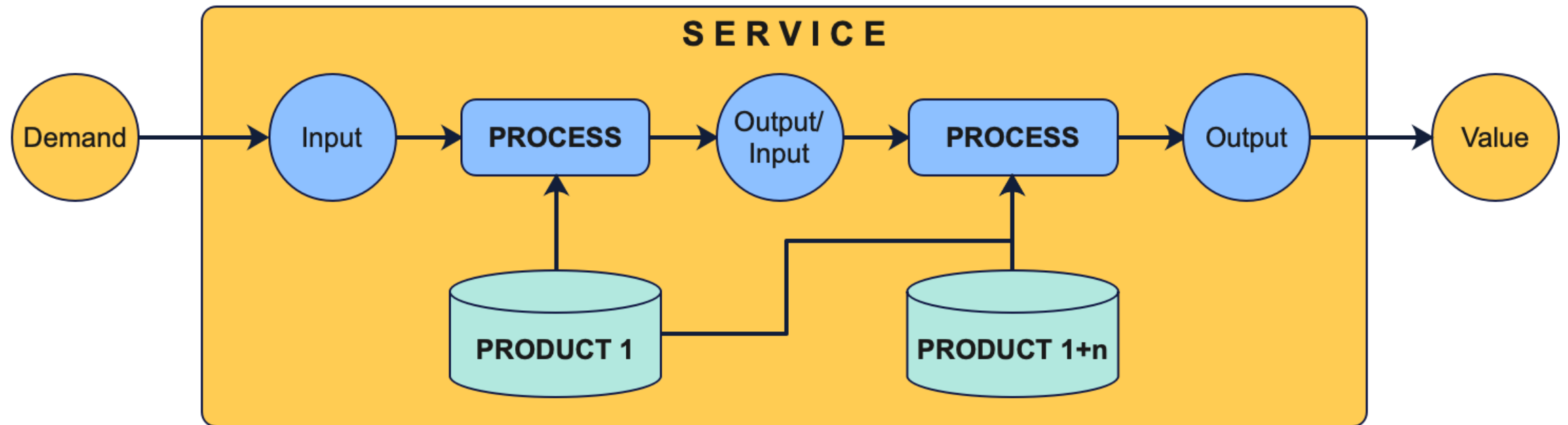


SERVICE **TERMINOLOGY**

GROUP DISCUSSION – MANAGEMENT OBJECTS

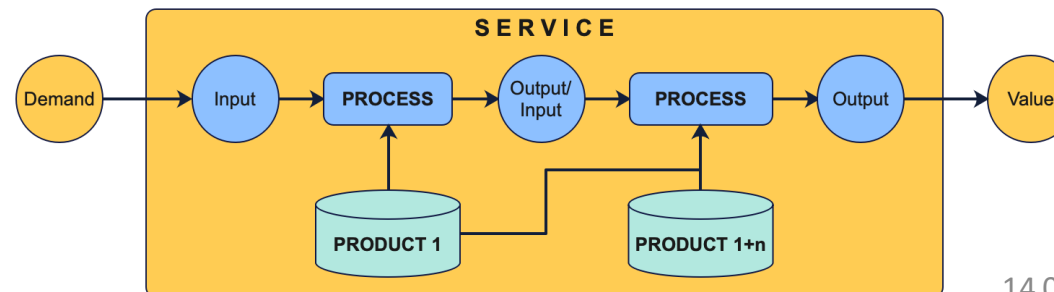
- What is:
 - A PROCESS
 - A SERVICE
 - A PRODUCT
 - VALUE
- Discuss in groups, write down your definitions, give examples.
- Present your thoughts
- Time: 10 minutes

DEFINITIONS: MANAGEMENT OBJECTS



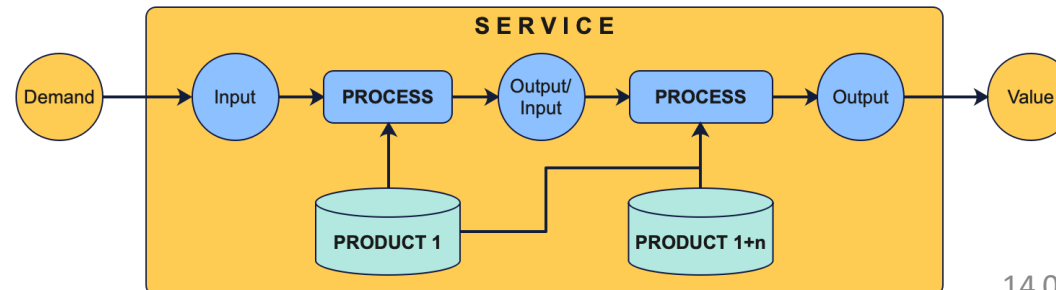
DEFINITIONS: MANAGEMENT OBJECTS – SERVICE & VALUE

- A **service** is the result of the co-creation of **processes** and **products**, the operation of which delivers the desired **value** of the **customer** (beneficiary in terms of ICT development, customer of the development) to the **user** (the beneficiary in terms of the result of the provision of the service, incl. the user of the product).
- **Value**: the perceived benefits, usefulness, and importance of something.
- The service exists only at the time of its provision.
- Example:
 - Product: railway crossing
 - Service: crossing the railway
 - Value to be delivered to the end user: safety when crossing the railway
 - The service exists only at those moments when any person or vehicle crosses the railway.



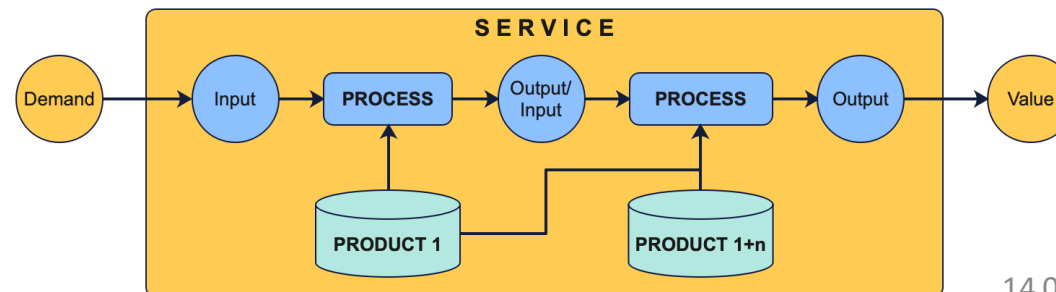
DEFINITIONS: MANAGEMENT OBJECTS - PRODUCT

- **A product** is a configuration of resources that is used to create value for beneficiaries.
- The product exists continuously regardless of its use or non-use.
- Example:
 - Product: railway crossing.
 - Human resources: maintenance team, surveillance team, etc.
 - Physical resources: traffic lights, barriers, sound equipment, etc.
 - Virtual resources: security system, traffic control system, etc.
 - The level crossing must be in order and operate 24/7 regardless of whether the beneficiaries (people, drivers) cross the railway or not.
- The above also applies to public sector products such as the population register or the state portal or a soldier.



DEFINITIONS: MANAGEMENT OBJECTS – PROCESS & RESOURCE

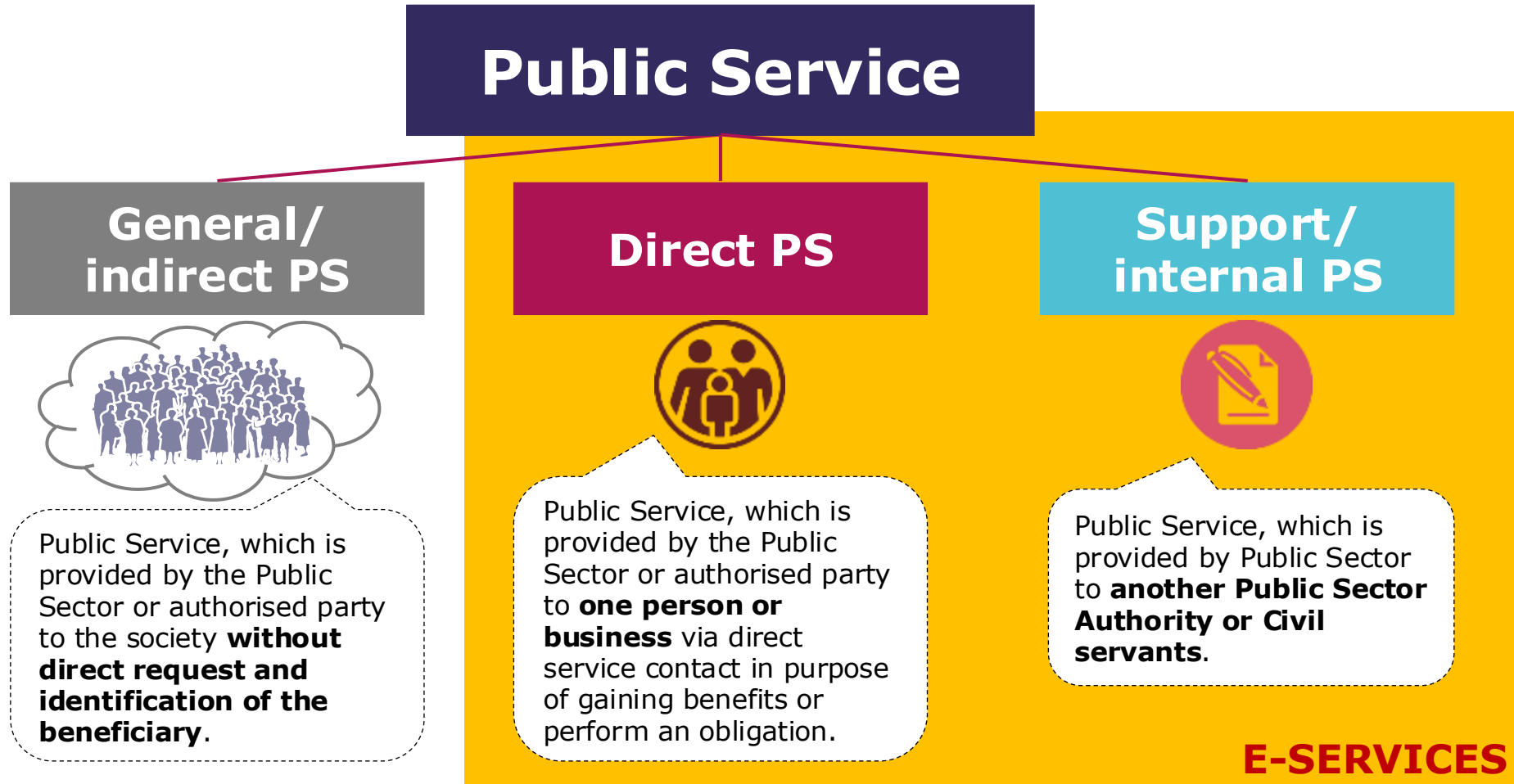
- **Process** - a set of interrelated or interacting activities that transform inputs into outputs. A process takes one or more defined inputs and turns them into defined outputs. Processes define the sequence of actions and their dependencies.
- **A resource** is a person or other physical (computer, refrigerator) or virtual (software, database, data) entity that is necessary to carry out an activity or achieve a goal. The resources used by the organization may belong to the organization itself (own employees, servers) or be used in accordance with the contract with the resource owner (outsourced programmers, data center).



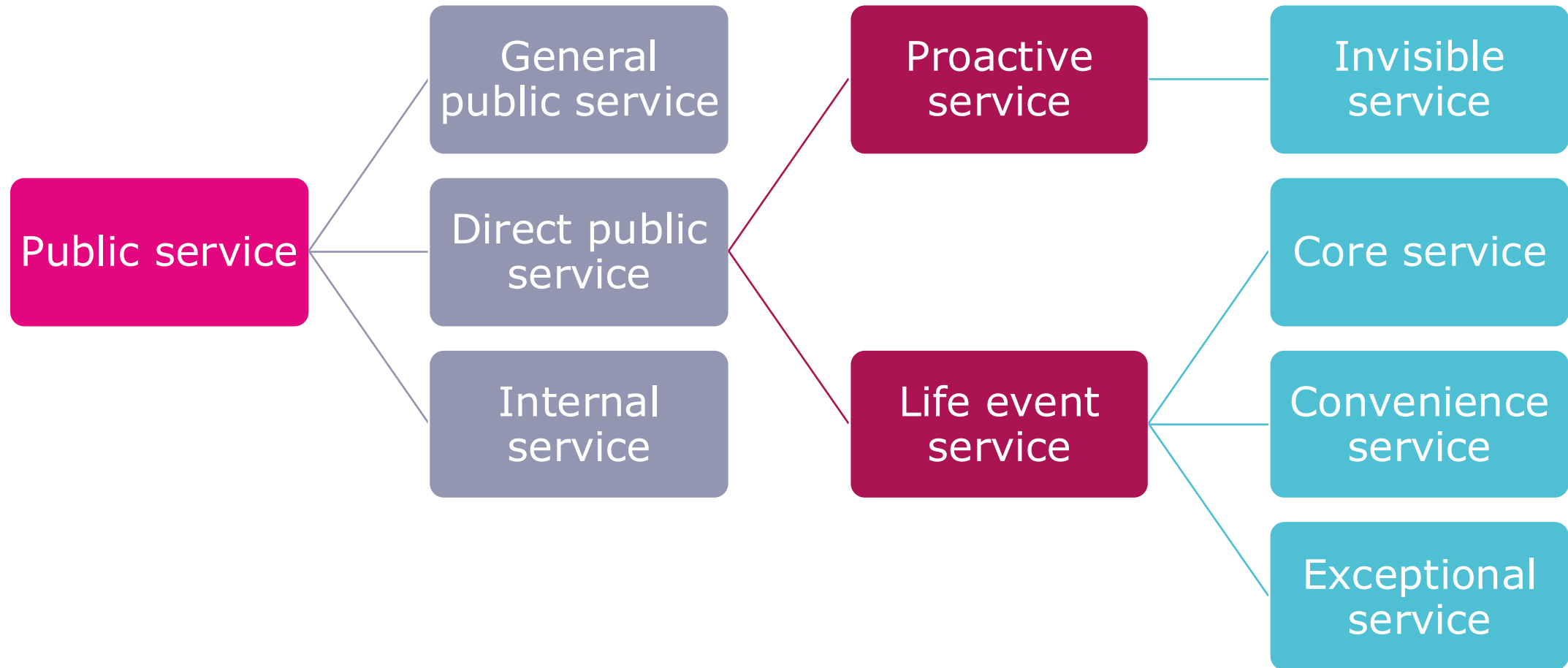
DEFINITIONS: PUBLIC SERVICE

- **Public service** - a service performed in the general interest in the performance of a public task, aimed at
 - the provision of public benefits,
 - the performance of an obligation or
 - the protection of fundamental rights, freedoms and interests.

DEFINITIONS: PUBLIC SERVICES



STRUCTURE OF THE PUBLIC SERVICES



DEFINITIONS: DIRECT PUBLIC SERVICES

- **Proactive service** – the direct public services provided by an authority on its own initiative in accordance with the presumed will of persons and based on the data in the databases belonging to the state information system. Proactive services are provided automatically or with the consent of a person.
- **Invisible service** – service is provided by Government without involvement of the requestor.
- **Event services** - the direct public services provided jointly by several authorities so that a person would be able to perform all the obligations and exercise all the rights conferred on the person due to an event or situation. An event service compiles several services (hereinafter *component service*) related to the same event into a single service for the user.

TERMINOLOGY - EVENTS

- **Life event** – a significant change in the state of affairs in a citizen's life where a public service may be required.
For example: getting a baby, becoming a crime victim, going to school, building a house.
- **Business event** - a significant change in the state of affairs in the lifecycle of a business that fulfils one or more needs or (legal) obligations of that business at this specific point in time. A business event requires a set of public services to be delivered and consumed in order for the associated business need(s) or obligation(s) to be fulfilled.
For example: starting a business, becoming multinational business, closing a business.
- Life or business event is reflected by one or more data events.
- **Data event** - is the reflection of a life event in the governmental registries and/or information systems.
For example: registration of pregnancy, registration of birth, registration of diploma, registration of working, registration of becoming unemployed, registration of the change of residence, registration of marriage, change in the health data, and registration of death.

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THANK YOU!

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mihkel.lauk@taltech.ee